KEY TOPIC 2 COURSE TEXTBOOK • CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1964–1973

THE ESCALATING CONFLICT

From the Water Wars and Six-Day War to the Yom Kippur Surprise



ARCHIVAL PRIMARY RECORD • 7 JUNE 1967 GPO-ISRAEL / ACC-1967-06-07

Paratroopers at the Western Wall (David Rubinger)

Israeli paratroopers Zion Karasenti, Yitzhak Yifat, and Haim Oshri stand before the Western Wall moments after capturing the Old City of Jerusalem.

GOVERNMENT PRESS OFFICE ARCHIVE EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION CONTENT — KEY TOPIC 2 COVERAGE

2.1 THE OUTBREAK OF WAR, 1967

- **Water Wars:** Arab diversion of River Jordan headwaters; Israeli strikes.
- **Border Tensions:** Samu reprisal raid; April 1967 Syrian air battles.
- **May 1967 Escalation:** Soviet false reports; Nasser expels UNEF peacekeepers.
- **Blockade:** Egyptian forces close Straits of Tiran; Arab pacts.
- **Casus Belli:** Israeli pre-emptive strike on 5 June 1967.

2.2 THE SIX-DAY WAR & IMPACT

- **Operation Focus:** Destruction of Egyptian Air Force in dawn blitz.
- **Triple Front Victory:** Sinai (Egypt), West Bank (Jordan), Golan (Syria).
- **Territorial Quadrupling:** Conquered lands create 1M new refugees.
- **Khartoum Summit:** Arab 'Three Noes' (No peace, recognition, talks).
- **UN Resolution 242:** 'Land for Peace' formula establishes basis for talks.

2.3 RESISTANCE & YOM KIPPUR

- **Armed Struggle:** Battle of Karameh (1968); Yasser Arafat leads PLO.
- **International Terror:** PFLP aircraft hijackings; Black September (1970).
- **Munich Olympics (1972):** Hostage crisis and Israeli reprisals.
- **Yom Kippur War (1973):** Egyptian canal crossing; Syrian assault.
- **Superpower Alert & Oil:** US-Soviet airlift crisis; OPEC oil embargo.

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS — CHRONOLOGY

- Jan 1964 — Cairo Summit: PLO Founded
- Nov 1966 — Samu Reprisal Raid in West Bank
- 7 Apr 67 — Air Dogfight: 6 Syrian MiGs Downed
- May 1967 — UNEF Expelled; Tiran Blockaded
- 5-10 Jun — Pre-emptive Six-Day Victory

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS — CHRONOLOGY

- 10 Jun 67 — Ceasefire: Territory Expands x3
- Sep 1967 — Khartoum 'Three Noes' Resolution
- Nov 1967 — UN Resolution 242 (Land for Peace)
- Sep 1970 — Dawson's Field & Black September
- Sep 1972 — Munich Olympics Hostage Massacre

CAUSAL CHAIN OF EVENTS — CHRONOLOGY

- 1969-70 — War of Attrition along Suez Canal
- Sep 1970 — Death of Nasser; Sadat President
- Jul 1972 — Sadat Expels 15,000 Soviets
- 6 Oct 73 — Surprise Assault on Yom Kippur
- 25 Oct 73 — Sharon Crossing & Res 338 Ceasefire

KEY TOPIC 2.1 SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.1 Enquiry: How Did Water, Border Raids, and Rhetoric Make a Second Arab-Israeli War Inevitable? (1964–1967)

Pearson Specification Focus: Significance of the 1964 Cairo Conference & growth of Fatah and the PLO • Escalating border tension: Syrian support for Fatah, the Samu reprisal raid, and the 7 April 1967 air dogfight • Pre-war actions of the USSR, Nasser, and the USA (UNEF expulsion & Straits of Tiran blockade).

The 1964 Cairo Conference & The Water Wars

[1.1] In **January 1964**, Arab League leaders gathered at the **Cairo Summit**, convened by Egyptian President **Gamal Abdel Nasser**. The catalyst was Israel's **National Water Carrier**, a pipeline diverting water from the **Sea of Galilee** to the **Negev desert** (see National Water Carrier Map). Arab leaders viewed this as economic expansionism. In response, the summit voted to establish the **Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO)** and approved an Arab plan to divert the **River Jordan headwaters** in Syria and Lebanon, threatening roughly one-third of Israel's freshwater supply (Source A).

[1.2] This dispute quickly ignited military clashes. Between **1964 and 1966**, Israeli tanks and aircraft bombarded Syrian engineering sites, halting the diversion canals. Simultaneously, **Yasser Arafat's Fatah** began cross-border guerrilla raids targeting Israeli water infrastructure and railways. Following a radical military coup in **February 1966**, Syria's new government openly sponsored Fatah's "popular liberation war" against Israel, transforming regional water disputes into active frontier warfare.

SOURCE A ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH January 1964

Arab Heads of State at the First Arab League Summit in Cairo (January 1964)



Egyptian State Information Service / Arab League Secretariat Archive, Cairo (Accession Ref: ARA-LEAG-1964-DOC08). January 1964

KEY FIGURE 1918–1970



Gamal Abdel Nasser

PRESIDENT OF EGYPT (1954–1970)

As the charismatic leader of Pan-Arab nationalism, Nasser faced intense domestic and regional pressure after the Samu and Golan clashes. His brinkmanship and closure of the Straits of Tiran directly triggered the pre-emptive Israeli air offensive.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Convened the 1964 Cairo Summit, creating the PLO to harness Palestinian nationalism under Arab control.
- Demanded the complete withdrawal of the UN Emergency Force (UNEF) from the Sinai buffer zone on 16 May 1967.
- Closed the Straits of Tiran to Israeli shipping on 22 May 1967, which Israel treated as an act of war.

Syrian Border Clashes & Israeli Reprisals

[2.1] Between **1965 and 1967**, the **Golan Heights** became the Middle East's most volatile frontier. Syrian artillery batteries atop the 1,000-foot volcanic plateau held tactical dominance over low-lying Israeli **kibbutzim** in the **Hula Valley** (Source B). Syrian gunners regularly shelled farmers cultivating disputed demilitarised zones, forcing Israeli tractors to be custom-armored and school children to sleep in reinforced underground bunkers.

[2.2] In response, Israeli Chief of Staff **Yitzhak Rabin** and Prime Minister **Levi Eshkol** enforced aggressive military retaliation, declaring that host Arab states were directly responsible for guerrilla raids. This hardline doctrine created an escalatory cycle: Fatah landmines triggered Israeli air strikes and artillery barrages, which in turn invited Syrian counter-bombardments and fueled Arab demands for war.

SOURCE B HISTORICAL MAP 1964–1967

The Syrian Armistice Line and Golan Heights Overlooking Israeli Settlements (1964–1967)



Department of Military Survey, Historical Topographical Record, Sheet 4 (Accession Ref: ISR-SYR-66). 1964–1967

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS

DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Straits of Tiran
Strategic maritime channel connecting Israel's southern port of Eilat to the Red Sea, blockaded by Nasser on 22 May 1967.

Pan-Arabism
Political ideology championed by Nasser aiming to unite Arab nations across the Middle East against Western imperialism and

Samu Reprisal (1966)
Large-scale IDF cross-border operation into the Jordanian West Bank following deadly Fatah mine attacks on Israeli border roads.

The Samu Raid & The 7 April 1967 Dogfight

[3.1] In late 1966, escalating friction triggered major military confrontations. On **11 November 1966**, a Fatah landmine killed three Israeli soldiers near the border. Despite **King Hussein of Jordan** attempting to curb guerrillas, Israel launched a massive daytime reprisal against the West Bank town of **Samu** on **13 November 1966**, destroying dozens of houses and killing 15 Jordanian soldiers. The Samu raid triggered violent riots across the West Bank against King Hussein.

[3.2] The decisive flashpoint occurred on **7 April 1967**. Following Syrian shelling of an Israeli tractor, an aerial battle erupted. Israeli **Mirage jets** shot down **six Syrian MiG-21s**, chasing them to Damascus (Source C). This humiliating defeat prompted Syrian broadcasts to accuse Nasser of cowardice for hiding behind **UNEF peacekeepers** in the Sinai, placing intense political pressure on Cairo to mobilize for war.

SOURCE C DIPLOMATIC DISPATCH 7 April 1967

The 7 April 1967 Air Battle and Arab Political Repercussions

"Following the shooting down of six Syrian MiG-21 fighters over Damascus on 7 April, intense political pressure has gripped both Damascus and Cairo. Syrian authorities and state media have expressed profound outrage at Egypt's failure to intervene, openly questioning the value of the November 1966 Egyptian-Syrian Defence Agreement. Radio Damascus and Syrian editorial columns have launched stinging taunts against President Gamal Abdel Nasser, pointedly asking why 100,000 Egyptian troops and hundreds of jet fighters remain inactive behind the shield of the United Nations Emergency Force (UNEF) in the Sinai Peninsula while Israeli aircraft strike Syrian territory with impunity. Western diplomatic observers in Cairo confirm that this sustained public humiliation has gravely damaged Nasser's prestige as the undisputed leader of the Arab world, making it virtually impossible for him to remain inactive during the next border crisis without facing complete political delegitimization."

Diplomatic Telegram, Foreign & Commonwealth Office Archive, Middle East Department (Ref: FCO 17/289, April 1967). 7 April 1967

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH RADIO CAIRO BROADCAST 26 May 1967

President Nasser's Address to Arab Trade Unionists

"The battle will be a general one and our basic objective will be to destroy Israel. We probably could not have said such things five or even three years ago. Today I say such words because I am confident. We are now ready to confront Israel in battle."

Voice of the Arabs / Egyptian State Information Service Cairo, 26 May 1967

Why Was War Inevitable by Spring 1967?

[4.1] By **May 1967**, war had become inevitable due to three converging catalysts: competition over the **River Jordan water supply**, state-sponsored **Fatah guerrilla sabotage**, and Israel's doctrine of **disproportionate military retaliation**. Each local clash escalated regional hostility beyond diplomatic control.

[4.2] Crucially, when false Soviet intelligence claimed in mid-May that Israel was massing twelve brigades to invade Syria, Nasser felt compelled to mobilize Egyptian troops into the Sinai. Neither side initially sought a total war, but rhetorical brinkmanship and interlocking mutual defense commitments made peaceful de-escalation impossible.

HISTORICAL CONTEXT WATER SECURITY & ESCALATION

The Battle Over the Headwaters: The Jordan River Diversion

In 1964, Israel completed its National Water Carrier, drawing freshwater from Lake Tiberias (Sea of Galilee) to irrigate the arid Negev Desert. In response, Arab League states launched the Headwater Diversion Scheme to divert the Dan and Banias tributaries away from Israel into Syria and Jordan, threatening 35% of Israel's freshwater supply. Israeli artillery strikes and airstrikes systematically obliterated the Syrian earthworks between 1965 and 1967. Simultaneously, Syrian artillery on the Golan Heights shelled Israeli kibbutzim in the Hula Valley below, turning regional water control into the initial catalyst of total war.

Key Causation: Proved that border escalation predated troop mobilizations: water security was viewed by Israeli military planners as an existential casus belli.

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • ESCALATING CRISIS & WATER WARS (1964–1967) CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. REGIONAL PROVOCATION:
Explain how Syrian shelling from the Golan Heights and support for Fatah border raids escalated tensions with Israel after the 1964 Cairo Summit.

2. SUPERPOWER MISCALCULATION:
How did Soviet false intelligence reports regarding Israeli troop build-ups lead Nasser to mobilize in Sinai and expel UNEF?

3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:
Why did Nasser's closure of the Straits of Tiran on 22 May 1967 represent an unambiguous casus belli (act of war) for the Israeli cabinet?

KEY TOPIC 2.2 SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.2 Enquiry: Why Was the Six-Day War Decided in Three Hours, and Did Nasser Intend to Fight? (May–June 1967)

Pearson Specification Focus: Key events and military turning points of the Six-Day War (5–10 June 1967) • Operation Focus dawn airstrikes against the Egyptian Air Force • Three-front combat: Sinai Peninsula, West Bank and East Jerusalem, and the Golan Heights • The ceasefire and the redrawn territorial map.

The Spiral into Crisis (May 1967)

[1.1] On **13 May 1967**, the Soviet Union gave Egyptian President **Gamal Abdel Nasser** false intelligence claiming Israel was massing twelve brigades to invade Syria. Though UN observers found no buildup, Nasser acted swiftly to reclaim Arab leadership: he deployed **100,000 troops and 1,000 tanks into Sinai**, expelled the **UN Emergency Force (UNEF)** on **16 May**, and closed the **Straits of Tiran** on **22 May**.

[1.2] Closing the Straits of Tiran severed Israel's sole maritime trade corridor to Asia and blocked 90% of its oil imports through **Eilat**—an explicit act of war (*casus belli*). When **King Hussein of Jordan** flew to Cairo on **30 May** to sign a mutual defense pact, Israel faced military encirclement. Fearing national destruction, Prime Minister **Levi Eshkol** formed a national unity government and appointed war hero **Moshe Dayan** as Minister of Defence to launch a pre-emptive strike.

SOURCE A ARCHIVAL COMMUNIQUÉ 22 May 1967

President Gamal Abdel Nasser Announces the Blockade of the Straits of Tiran (22 May 1967)

"The armed forces of the United Arab Republic have reoccupied Sharm el-Sheikh... We will not allow the Israeli flag to pass through the Gulf of Aqaba. Our basic objective will be the destruction of Israel. This war will be a total war and our basic aim will be to destroy Israel."

Presidential Address at UAR Advanced Air HQ / Egyptian State Information Service (22 May 1967) — 22 May 1967

The Pre-Emptive Dawn Airstrike (5 June 1967)

[2.1] At **7:45 am on 5 June 1967**, Israel launched a **pre-emptive dawn airstrike**. Leaving only twelve jets to defend home skies, nearly 200 Israeli aircraft flew low over the Mediterranean–just 30 feet above the waves–to evade Egyptian radar. They struck seventeen Egyptian airbases from the west at breakfast time, catching Egyptian pilots completely unprepared.

[2.2] Using rocket-boosted cratering bombs, Israeli pilots cratered runways before strafing parked aircraft. In under three hours, over **300 Egyptian combat planes** were destroyed on the ground (Source A). When Syria and Jordan launched retaliatory air strikes, Israeli jets destroyed their air forces as well, winning total air supremacy and leaving Arab ground forces completely exposed.

SOURCE B ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH 5 June 1967

Destroyed Egyptian Jet Aircraft at Bir Gifgafa Airfield, Sinai (5 June 1967)



IDF Military Archive, Western Sinai Campaign Collection (Accession Ref: AIR-1967-0506). — 5 June 1967

KEY FIGURE 1915–1981



Moshe Dayan

ISRAELI MINISTER OF DEFENCE (1967–1974)

Dayan became the global symbol of Israeli military dominance and deterrence. His aggressive operational tempo secured total victory across three fronts within 132 hours, fundamentally transforming Middle Eastern borders.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Appointed Minister of Defence on 1 June 1967 amid national crisis to unify the Israeli war cabinet.
- Authorised the pre-emptive dawn air strike that destroyed the Egyptian Air Force on the tarmac.
- Directed three-front combat operations that captured the Sinai Peninsula, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and the Golan Heights.

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Operation Focus

Preemptive Strike

Triple Front

Three Fronts in Six Days

[3.1] With air superiority secured, Israeli ground forces swept across three fronts. In the **Sinai Peninsula**, armored divisions led by **Ariel Sharon** shattered Egyptian defensive lines. In panic, Egypt's military command ordered an uncoordinated retreat, leaving hundreds of tanks abandoned as Israeli forces reached the **Suez Canal** within four days.

[3.2] On the eastern front, Jordan began shelling West Jerusalem. Israeli forces counter-attacked into the **West Bank**, and on **7 June**, paratroopers secured the **Old City of Jerusalem** and the holy **Western Wall** (Source B). Finally, on **9–10 June**, Israeli forces scaled the fortified cliffs of the **Golan Heights**, routing Syrian artillery before a UN ceasefire ended the war.

SOURCE C ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH 7 June 1967

Israeli Paratroopers at the Western Wall, Jerusalem (David Rubinger, 7 June 1967)



Photograph by David Rubinger, Israel Government Press Office (Accession Ref: GPO-D597-088). 7 June 1967

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH IDF GENERAL STAFF ORDER 5 June 1967

Chief of Staff Yitzhak Rabin's Order of the Day

"Soldiers of the Israel Defense Forces! Today our armed forces strike at the forces arrayed to annihilate our people. We go into battle not to conquer, but to secure our survival in our ancestral land. The fate of Israel rests upon your courage and discipline."

IDF General Staff Historical Archive Tel Aviv Command, 5 June 1967

How the Map Changed in Six Days

[4.1] In just six days, Israel quadrupled its territory, capturing the **Sinai Peninsula, Gaza Strip, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and the Golan Heights**. Israeli losses were under 1,000 soldiers, while Arab armies suffered over **15,000 Egyptian, 6,000 Jordanian, and 1,000 Syrian casualties**.

[4.2] While these conquests provided strategic buffer zones, they brought over **one million Palestinian Arabs under Israeli military occupation**, sparking a fresh refugee exodus. The catastrophic humiliation suffered by Arab states ensured that rather than securing permanent peace, the 1967 war laid the groundwork for future armed conflict.

[4.3] In geopolitical terms, the sweeping Israeli victory transformed Cold War dynamics across the Middle East. The Soviet Union severed diplomatic relations with Israel and launched a multi-billion-dollar emergency rearmament of Egypt and Syria. Meanwhile, the United States recognized Israel as its primary regional strategic ally, initiating large-scale military assistance that solidified the post-1967 **regional balance of power**.

TACTICAL MASTERSTROKE OPERATION MOKED • JUNE 1967

Operation Focus (Moked): The 170-Minute Air Blitz

At 07:45 on 5 June 1967, Israeli Air Force commander Mordechai Hod committed 196 of Israel's 208 combat jets to a daring pre-emptive strike. Flying radar-evading routes just 50 feet above the Mediterranean waves under radio silence, Israeli Mirage and Vautour aircraft struck 19 Egyptian airbases simultaneously using specialized rocket-assisted runway-cratering bombs ('Dibber'). In less than three hours, 309 of Egypt's 340 combat aircraft were demolished on the tarmac. By midday, Hod redirected sorties against Syrian and Jordanian airfields, destroying a further 60 aircraft and winning absolute regional air dominance.

Decisive Factor: Total air supremacy allowed Israeli armored divisions under Tal, Sharon, and Yoffe to advance across Sinai and the West Bank without threat of air interdiction.

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • MILITARY DOCTRINE & THE THREE FRONTS (JUNE 1967) CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. OPERATION FOCUS:
Why was the Israeli Air Force's surprise dawn blitz on 5 June 1967 decisive in determining the entire outcome of the Six-Day War?

2. MULTI-FRONT ADVANCE:
Explain why Jordan entered the war despite Israeli warnings, and describe the consequences for East Jerusalem and the West Bank.

3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:
Was Israeli victory primarily the result of brilliant tactical planning (pre-emption) or disastrous Arab disunity and military incompetence?

KEY TOPIC 2.3 SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.3 Enquiry: "Land for Peace" or Permanent Stalemate: How Did the 1967 Conquered Territories Transform the Conflict?

Pearson Specification Focus: Significance of the newly occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai, and East Jerusalem • The Palestinian refugee crisis • The Khartoum Arab League Summit and the 'Three Noes' • UN Resolution 242 ('Land for Peace') and the Suez Canal dispute.

The Reality of the Occupied Territories (Summer 1967)

[1.1] The June 1967 ceasefire left Israel in control of vast lands (Source A): the **Sinai Peninsula and Gaza Strip** from Egypt, the **West Bank and East Jerusalem** from Jordan, and the **Golan Heights** from Syria. These created natural buffer zones—the Suez Canal, Jordan River, and Golan cliffs—shielding Israel's heartland from surprise ground assault.

[1.2] However, occupation created immense humanitarian dilemmas. Israel brought over **one million Palestinian Arabs** under military administration, while **300,000 Palestinians** fled across the Jordan River into refugee camps. Israel immediately annexed **East Jerusalem** as its unified capital and soon authorized the first civilian Jewish settlements in the **Jordan Valley** and **Gush Etzion**, entrenching future territorial disputes.

The Khartoum Summit & The "Three Noes"

[2.1] To coordinate an Arab response to defeat, eight Arab heads of state convened in **Khartoum, Sudan**, in **August 1967**. While King Hussein urged quiet diplomacy to reclaim lost lands, hardliners led by Nasser insisted that negotiating from weakness would legitimize Israeli conquest and humiliate the Arab world.

[2.2] The conference concluded with the famous **"Three Noes" of Khartoum**: *"No peace with Israel, no recognition of Israel, no negotiations with it"* (Source B). To Israelis, this rigid stance proved Arab leaders remained dedicated to Israel's destruction, leading Israel's cabinet to abandon early plans for territorial compromise and harden resolve to retain the occupied territories.

SOURCE A HISTORICAL MAP June 1967

The Conquered Occupied Territories Following the Six-Day War (June 1967)



Central Intelligence Agency Cartographic Center / United Nations Disengagement Observer Force Archive (Accession Ref: UN-MAP-1967-ME). June 1967

SOURCE B ARCHIVAL COMMUNIQUÉ 1 September 1967

The Khartoum Arab League Summit Resolution (1 September 1967)

"The Arab Heads of State have agreed to united political efforts at the international and diplomatic level to eliminate the effects of aggression and to ensure the withdrawal of the aggressive Israeli forces from the Arab lands which have been occupied since the aggression of 5 June. This will be done within the framework of the main principles by which the Arab States abide, namely: no peace with Israel, no recognition of Israel, no negotiations with it, and adherence to the rights of the Palestinian people in their own country."

Arab League Summit Records, Khartoum Communiqué, Clause 3 (1 September 1967). 1 September 1967

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Occupied Territories
The West Bank, Gaza, Golan Heights, and Sinai Peninsula captured by Israel in 1967 and placed under military administration.

UN Resolution 242
Adopted in November 1967 establishing the "Land for Peace" principle, calling for Israeli withdrawal from occupied territories.

Three No's of Khartoum
Arab League declaration (Sept 1967): "No peace with Israel, no recognition of Israel, no negotiations with it."

UN Resolution 242 & "Land for Peace"

[3.1] On **22 November 1967**, the UN Security Council unanimously passed **Resolution 242**, establishing the **"Land for Peace"** principle. Drafted by Britain's Lord Caradon, it asserted the "inadmissibility of the acquisition of territory by war," calling for Israeli armed forces to withdraw from occupied areas in return for Arab states recognizing Israel's right to live in peace within secure borders.

[3.2] However, deliberate linguistic ambiguity crippled implementation. The English text called for withdrawal from *"territories occupied"* (some territories), whereas the French text specified *"des territoires occupés"* (all territories) (Source C). Furthermore, Resolution 242 addressed Palestinians only as a generic "refugee problem," entirely omitting their national right to self-determination.

SOURCE C DIPLOMATIC TREATY 22 November 1967

Article 1(i) of UN Security Council Resolution 242 in English and French

"Article 1(i) of UN Security Council Resolution 242 (Adopted 22 November 1967): [Official English Text – Drafted by Lord Caradon, UK]: 'Affirms that the fulfilment of Charter principles requires the establishment of a just and lasting peace in the Middle East which should include the application of both the following principles: (i) Withdrawal of Israel armed forces from territories occupied in the recent conflict...' [Official French Text – Equally Authoritative Official UN Record]: 'Affirme que l\'accomplissement des principes de la Charte exige l\'instauration d\'une paix juste et durable au Moyen-Orient, qui devrait comprendre l\'application des deux principes suivants: (i) Retrait des forces armées israéliennes des territoires occupés lors du récent conflit...' [Linguistic Significance]: The English text deliberately omits the definite article 'the' ('from territories occupied'), enabling Israel to argue it is only required to withdraw from SOME occupied territories to secure defensible borders. Conversely, the French text uses 'des territoires occupés' ('from THE occupied territories'), enabling Arab governments to insist that international law mandates complete withdrawal from ALL occupied lands."

United Nations Security Council Official Records, 22 November 1967 (Resolution 242 / S/RES/242). 22 November 1967

KEY FIGURE 1898–1978



Golda Meir

PRIME MINISTER OF ISRAEL (1969–1974)

Known as the 'Iron Lady' of Israeli politics, Meir maintained uncompromising diplomatic resolve following the 1967 war, adhering strictly to 'secure borders' and refusing unilateral territorial concessions without mutual recognition.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Assumed the premiership in March 1969 following the death of Levi Eshkol, governing during the War of Attrition.
- Consolidated Israeli control over the conquered territories, fortifying the Bar-Lev Line along the Suez Canal.
- Firmly rejected unconditional withdrawal without direct, face-to-face Arab peace treaties and recognized borders.

The Roots of Entrenched Conflict

[4.1] In the long term, the 1967 conquests replaced the quest for peace with a diplomatic stalemate. Israel fortified its borders—building the **Bar-Lev Line** along the Suez Canal—and subsidized Jewish settlements, while Arab leaders maintained the Khartoum "Three Noes."

[4.2] Consequently, Palestinians concluded that conventional Arab armies would never liberate their homeland, accelerating the growth of independent guerrilla groups like the **PLO**. Without diplomatic progress, Resolution 242 could not avert the impending **War of Attrition** and the **1973 Yom Kippur War**.

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • OCCUPIED LANDS & DIPLOMATIC DEADLOCK (1967) CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. STRATEGIC DEPTH:

2. KHARTOUM SUMMIT:

3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:

KEY TOPIC 2.4 SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.4: The Rise of Palestinian Resistance: The PLO, Black September & Munich (1968–1972)

Pearson Specification Focus: The rise of independent Palestinian armed resistance • Use of international terrorism, Israeli responses, and changing world attitudes: PFLP commercial aircraft hijackings to Dawson's Field (1970) • King Hussein's expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (Black September) • The 1972 Munich Olympics massacre.

From Dependence to Armed Resistance (1968–1969)

[1.1] The 1967 defeat shattered Palestinian faith in Arab leaders like Nasser. Concluding they had to liberate their homeland themselves, young Palestinians joined armed guerrilla groups (*fedayeen*). On **21 March 1968**, at the **Battle of Karameh** in Jordan, **Yasser Arafat's Fatah** fighters and Jordanian artillery fiercely resisted an Israeli armored reprisal raid.

[1.2] Although Israel destroyed the guerrilla camp, Fatah inflicted 28 Israeli fatalities. Karameh was celebrated across the Arab world as a heroic moral victory. Thousands of recruits joined Fatah, and in **February 1969**, **Yasser Arafat** was elected Chairman of the **Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO)**, converting it into an independent armed national movement.

SOURCE A ARCHIVAL COMMUNIQUÉ 21 March 1968

Fatah Communiqué No. 12 Following the Battle of Karameh (21 March 1968)

"In the town of Karameh, the fighters of Fatah and the Palestinian resistance stood shoulder to shoulder against Israeli armor... The myth of Israeli invincibility has been buried forever in the Jordan Valley. Thousands of our youth are flocking to join the armed revolution."

Fatah Military High Command / PLO Central Archive, Amman (March 1968) — 21 March 1968

KEY FIGURE 1929–2004



Yasser Arafat

CHAIRMAN OF THE PLO / LEADER OF FATAH (1969–2004)

Arafat transformed the Palestinian cause from a passive refugee dilemma into an autonomous political and paramilitary movement, demonstrating that Palestinians would fight independently rather than wait for Arab armies.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Led Fatah armed guerrillas at the 1968 Battle of Karameh, boosting Palestinian recruitment and prestige.
- Elected Chairman of the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) in 1969, shifting it to independent armed struggle.
- Established an armed state-within-a-state in Jordan until expelled during the brutal Black September civil war of 1970.

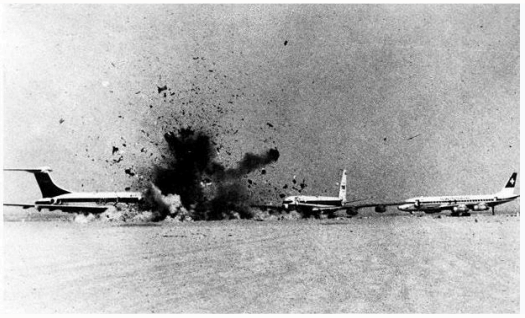
Dawson's Field & The Crisis of Black September (1970)

[2.1] By **1970**, Palestinian guerrillas operated as a "state within a state" in Jordan, defying King Hussein's laws. To capture international attention, George Habash's Marxist **PFLP** pioneered airline hijackings. In **September 1970**, militants hijacked four Western jetliners, forcing three to land at **Dawson's Field** in the Jordanian desert.

[2.2] After evacuating over 300 passengers, the hijackers blew up the empty airliners on camera (Source A). Viewing this as a direct challenge to his monarchy, **King Hussein** declared martial law on **17 September 1970**. In the brutal civil conflict known as **Black September**, the Jordanian army crushed Palestinian militias, expelling the PLO to **southern Lebanon** by 1971.

SOURCE B ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH 12 September 1970

PFLP Militants Detonating Hijacked Commercial Airliners at Dawson's Field, Jordan (12 September 1970)



Associated Press Photo Archive, Amman Bureau (Accession Ref: AP-JOR-1970-0912). — 12 September 1970

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Fatah & The PLO
Palestinian nationalist political and military organization founded by Yasser Arafat, committed to armed liberation of Palestine.

Black September (1970)
Armed conflict between Jordanian Armed Forces under King Hussein and the PLO, resulting in the expulsion of Palestinian guerrilla leadership to Lebanon.

Munich Olympics (1972)
Terrorist attack by the Black September faction taking eleven Israeli Olympic team members hostage, culminating in their murder at Fürstenfeldbruck airport.

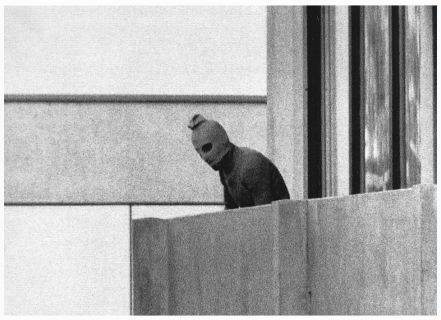
The 1972 Munich Olympics Massacre

[3.1] Exiled in Lebanon, a radical covert faction named **Black September** sought revenge. On **5 September 1972**, during the **Munich Olympic Games**, eight Black September gunmen infiltrated the Olympic Village, killing two Israeli athletes and taking nine others hostage.

[3.2] Militants demanded the release of 234 Palestinian prisoners. Israeli Prime Minister **Golda Meir** refused to negotiate with terrorists. A botched West German rescue attempt at Fürstenfeldbruck airbase ended in disaster: all nine Israeli hostages, five terrorists, and one German policeman were killed (Source B). In response, Meir launched **Operation Wrath of God**, authorizing Mossad to track down and assassinate the organizers.

SOURCE C ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH 5 September 1972

Masked Black September Gunman on the Balcony at Munich Olympic Village (5 September 1972)



Kurt Strumpf / Associated Press Archive (Accession Ref: AP-MUC-1972-0509). 5 September 1972

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH CABINET SECURITY DIRECTIVE September 1972

Golda Meir's Directive: Operation Wrath of God

Following the massacre of eleven Israeli Olympic athletes in Munich, Prime Minister Golda Meir authorized Mossad to track down and assassinate every Black September planner across Europe and the Middle East, declaring: "We have no choice but to strike at the terrorist organizations wherever we can reach them."

Prime Minister's Office Classified Minutes Jerusalem Security Committee, September 1972

Did Terrorism Help or Harm the Cause?

[4.1] International terrorism had contradictory outcomes. On one hand, high-profile attacks like Munich thrust the Palestinian national struggle onto the world stage, forcing the UN in **1974** to recognize the PLO as the legitimate representative of the Palestinian people.

[4.2] On the other hand, terrorism caused severe strategic harm. It provoked the bloodshed of Black September, alienated Western public opinion, and invited devastating Israeli reprisals. Recognising that violence alone could not defeat Israel, Arafat began steering the PLO toward international diplomacy by the mid-1970s.

HISTORICAL TURNING POINT GUERRILLA LEGITIMACY • MARCH 1968

The Battle of Karameh: How a Tactical Clash Created a Legend

On 21 March 1968, 15,000 Israeli soldiers launched a punitive raid across the Jordan River into the town of Karameh to destroy PLO basecamps. Anticipating the assault, Yasser Arafat ordered Fatah commandos to stand their ground alongside the Jordanian Army's 1st Infantry Division. Despite suffering 156 dead and the destruction of the town, Palestinian fighters destroyed 4 Israeli tanks and inflicted 28 IDF fatalities. Arafat framed Karameh as the first time Arab fighters stood against the IDF without fleeing, sparking a massive surge in Palestinian nationalist enlistment across the Middle East.

Key Significance: Transformed Fatah from an obscure guerrilla fringe into the dominant political vanguard of the Palestinian national movement.

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • ARMED STRUGGLE & INTERNATIONAL TERRORISM (1968–1972) CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. INDEPENDENCE OF THE PLO:
How did the 1968 Battle of Karameh transform Yasser Arafat and Fatah into the dominant force within the Palestinian national movement?

2. CIVIL WAR IN JORDAN:
Why did the PFLP Dawson's Field hijackings prompt King Hussein to launch military action against the PLO in "Black September" 1970?

3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:
Did the 1972 Munich Olympics massacre succeed in putting the Palestinian cause onto the world stage, or did it permanently alienate international sympathy?

KEY TOPIC 2.5 SPECIFICATION ENQUIRY • 1964–1973

KT 2.5: The War of Attrition & The Yom Kippur War (1969–1973)

Pearson Specification Focus: Egyptian relations with Israel, the superpowers (USA/USSR), and the Arab world under Nasser and Sadat • The War of Attrition (1969–70) and Israel's consolidation of occupied lands • Key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973): Egyptian Suez crossing, Syrian assault, IDF counter-encirclement, and the OPEC oil crisis.

The Impasse of Attrition & Anwar Sadat's Plan (1969–1973)

[1.1] Between **1969 and 1970**, Nasser waged the **War of Attrition** across the Suez Canal, attempting to exhaust Israeli forces through relentless artillery bombardments. In response, Israel built the **Bar-Lev Line**, a fortified chain of sand ramparts over 60 feet high. A US-brokered ceasefire ended fighting in August 1970 after thousands of deaths, leaving frontlines unchanged.

[1.2] Following Nasser's death in **September 1970**, new Egyptian President **Anwar Sadat** developed a pragmatic military strategy. Realising Egypt's economy was crippled and Israel would never surrender Sinai through diplomacy while holding military superiority, Sadat planned a limited surprise offensive to shatter the myth of Israeli invincibility and force American diplomatic intervention.

SOURCE A HISTORICAL DOCUMENT 1969–1972

Archival Intelligence Report: The Construction and Doctrine of the Israeli Bar-Lev Line Along the Suez Canal (1969–1972)

"The Bar-Lev Line consists of thirty-five fortified strongpoints (Maozim) sunk into sand ramparts sixty feet above the waterline, backed by concrete artillery emplacements and oil-pipe flame barriers. Designed to withstand weeks of sustained Egyptian bombardment, it provides total tactical security for Israeli forces in Sinai."

IDF General Staff Historical Division, Tel Aviv (Accession Ref: IDF-SUEZ-BL-1971) 1969–1972

KEY FIGURE 1918–1981



Anwar Sadat

PRESIDENT OF EGYPT (1970–1981)

Sadat used limited military warfare not to destroy Israel, but to break the diplomatic stalemate, force superpower intervention, and regain Arab honor, paving the way for eventual peace negotiations.

STRATEGIC DECISIONS & ACTIONS:

- Succeeded Nasser in 1970 and expelled 15,000 Soviet military advisers in 1972 to gain independent strategic freedom.
- Orchestrated a synchronized surprise attack with Syria on Yom Kippur (6 October 1973).
- Breached the Bar-Lev Line using high-pressure water cannons, shattering the myth of Israeli invincibility.

The Surprise Assault on the Holy Day (6 October 1973)

[2.1] On **6 October 1973**, at 2:00 pm, Egypt and Syria launched a joint surprise attack on **Yom Kippur** (the holiest day in Judaism) during the Muslim holy month of **Ramadan**. With Israeli soldiers on leave, Syrian tanks assaulted the Golan Heights while **80,000 Egyptian infantry** crossed the Suez Canal under a 2,000-gun artillery barrage.

[2.2] Egyptian engineers used high-pressure water cannons to blast breaches through the Bar-Lev sand ramparts within hours (Source A). Israeli tank and air counter-attacks were shattered by Soviet-supplied **SAM-6 anti-aircraft missiles** and wire-guided **Sagger anti-tank missiles**, inflicting heavy early losses on Israeli forces.

SOURCE B ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH October 1973

Egyptian Infantry and Armored Columns Crossing the Suez Canal (October 1973)



Egyptian Armed Forces Directorate of Moral Affairs (Accession Ref: EGY-1973-1006). October 1973

KEY SPECIFICATION TERMINOLOGY & CONCEPTS DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

Bar-Lev Line
Massive chain of 35 fortified Israeli bunkers and 60-foot sand ramparts along the east bank of the Suez Canal, built after 1967 to repel Egyptian amphibious assault

Operation Badr (1973)
Egyptian assault crossing the Suez Canal on Yom Kippur, deploying high-pressure water cannons to blast breaches through the Bar-Lev Line ramparts

OPEC Oil Embargo
Decision by Arab oil-producing states to cut petroleum production and embargo Western supporters of Israel, quadrupling global oil prices

Superpower Airlifts, Sharon's Crossing & The Oil Weapon

[3.1] Prime Minister **Golda Meir** appealed to the US, prompting President Nixon to launch a massive military airlift, matched by a Soviet airlift to Arab armies. After halting Syrian armor on the Golan, Israeli general **Ariel Sharon** led armored forces across the Suez Canal on 15 October, encircling Egypt's **Third Army** (Source B).

[3.2] On **17 October 1973**, Arab **OPEC** members deployed the **oil weapon**, cutting oil production and embargoing the US. Crude oil prices quadrupled, causing global inflation and fuel shortages. When Soviet intervention threatened a superpower nuclear showdown, US Secretary of State **Henry Kissinger** negotiated a UN ceasefire on **24 October 1973**.

SOURCE C ARCHIVAL PHOTOGRAPH October 1973

Israeli Armored Vehicles and Tanks Crossing the Suez Canal to the West Bank (October 1973)



IDF Military Archive, Southern Command Photographic Unit (Accession Ref: YKW-1973-1018). October 1973

ARCHIVAL DISPATCH PRESIDENTIAL WAR DIRECTIVE 5 October 1973

President Anwar Sadat's Strategic War Directive

"The strategic objective of the Egyptian armed forces is to challenge Israeli military doctrine by launching a military action... to shatter the theory of Israeli security and force a political crisis that will compel international intervention to resolve the stalemate."

Egyptian Supreme Council of the Armed Forces War Directive No. 41, 5 October 1973

The Turning Point Towards Peace

[4.1] The 1973 war was a psychological earthquake. For Israel, losing over **2,600 soldiers** shattered military complacency, prompting the **Agranat Commission** inquiry and the resignations of military leaders and Prime Minister Golda Meir in 1974.

[4.2] For Egypt, crossing the canal restored national pride, giving Sadat the political authority to negotiate with Israel from strength. The crisis convinced Israel that occupation did not ensure security, while the oil embargo forced US commitment to regional peacemaking—paving the way for **Kissinger's shuttle diplomacy** and the **1978 Camp David Accords**.

ENGINEERING TRIUMPH OPERATION BADR • OCTOBER 1973

Breaching the Bar-Lev Line: The High-Pressure Water Cannons

The Israeli Bar-Lev Line was shielded by a 60-foot-high sand rampart along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal, calculated by Western engineers to require 24 to 48 hours and heavy explosives to breach. Egyptian military engineer General Baki Zaki Yousef proposed using commercial British-built high-pressure water pumps. Mounting 450 pumps on pontoon barges, Egyptian engineering units blasted 81 separate breaches through 3 million cubic meters of sand in less than five hours, enabling 100,000 soldiers and 1,020 tanks to surge into Sinai before the IDF could mobilize.

Strategic Shock: Shattered Israel's doctrine of 'The Concept' (Hamusag)—the misplaced conviction that Arab armies lacked the technical sophistication to mount a crossing.

KEY ENQUIRY CHECK • SURPRISE OFFENSIVE & SUPERPOWER CRISIS (1969–1973) CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. TACTICAL SURPRISE:
How did Sadat and Assad coordinate Operation Badr on Yom Kippur to breach the Bar-Lev Line and seize the Golan Heights?

2. THE SHARON COUNTER-ATTACK:
Explain how General Sharon's division exploited the seam between Egypt's Second and Third Armies to encircle Suez City.

3. EVALUATIVE HINGE:
Why did the 1973 war restore Arab military honour while simultaneously convincing Sadat that Israel could not be destroyed by force?

KEY TOPIC 2: CHRONOLOGY & DISCIPLINARY MASTERY (1964–1973)

Comprehensive revision index of vital historical turning points, diplomatic resolutions, and Edexcel examination question frameworks.

KEY TOPIC 2 MASTER TIMELINE • CRITICAL CHRONOLOGICAL SEQUENCE

Jan 1964	**Cairo Arab League Summit**	Arab states endorse headwater diversion scheme against Israel's National Water Carrier; PLO created.
Nov 1966	**Samu Reprisal Raid**	IDF launches heavy raid into Jordanian West Bank after Fatah mine kills 3 soldiers; radicalizes West Bank.
7 Apr 1967	**Tractor War Air Dogfight**	Syrian shelling of DMZ tractors leads to dogfight; IAF downs 6 Syrian MiGs and flies over Damascus.
May 1967	**Sinai Mobilization & Blockade**	Soviet disinformation prompts Nasser to demand UNEF withdrawal and close Straits of Tiran.
5 Jun 1967	**Operation Focus (Moked)**	IAF pre-emptive dawn strike neutralizes Egyptian air force on runways, establishing complete air dominance.
5–10 Jun 1967	**The Six-Day War**	IDF captures Sinai, Gaza Strip, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and Syrian Golan Heights; territory expands x3.
Sep 1967	**Khartoum Resolution**	Eight Arab heads of state proclaim the 'Three Noes': No peace, no recognition, no negotiations with Israel.
22 Nov 1967	**UN Resolution 242**	Security Council establishes 'Land for Peace' formula: Israeli withdrawal in exchange for recognized boundaries.
21 Mar 1968	**Battle of Karameh**	Fatah fighters and Jordanian army resist IDF raid, transforming Arafat into an international Palestinian icon.
Sep 1970	**Dawson's Field & Black September**	PFLP hijacks 4 planes to Jordan; King Hussein unleashes army to crush and expel PLO fedayeen to Lebanon.
Sep 1972	**Munich Olympics Massacre**	Black September murders 11 Israeli Olympic athletes; Israel responds with 'Operation Wrath of God'.
6–25 Oct 1973	**The Yom Kippur War**	Coordinated Egyptian-Syrian surprise crossing of Suez and Golan; Sharon counter-encirclement; OPEC oil crisis.

KEY DISCIPLINARY TERMINOLOGY

- **Casus Belli:** An act or event that provokes or is used to justify a declaration of war.
- **Pre-emptive Strike:** A military attack launched to repel or defeat an imminent offensive.
- **Strategic Depth:** Distances between frontiers and core civilian/industrial population centres.
- **Land for Peace:** Legal principle of returning occupied territory in exchange for recognized peace.
- **Asymmetrical Warfare:** Armed conflict between belligerents whose military power differs vastly.
- **The Concept (Hamusag):** Pre-1973 Israeli intelligence assumption that Egypt would not attack without air parity.

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 EXAMINATION FRAMEWORKS

Q1: Explain one consequence of... [4 Marks]
Model Focus: State one clear consequence • Support with precise factual detail (names, dates, figures) • Explain the resulting historical impact on regional tension.

Q2: Write an analytical narrative explaining... [8 Marks]
Model Focus: 3-stage causal sequencing (Catalyst • Escalation • Outcome) • Connect each step with explicit analytical connectives (Consequently, This directly led to).

Q3: Explain two of the following... [16 Marks]
Model Focus: 2 sustained PEEL paragraphs per chosen option • Prioritize causal mechanisms over simple narrative • Conclude with clear comparative significance.